

Cloud Hosting

Cloud Hosting has completely changed the way applications are written for the web, deployed on the web, and distributed to users. Let us take a look at how cloud hosting works as a concept.

SINGLE SERVER HOSTING VS. CLOUD HOSTING. AND THEN SOME...

Hosting multiple websites on a single server has been done from quite a while. Most web hosts will offer something called shared hosting in which one machine will be serving multiple websites. It is a cheap way to get started with a

website, however it still has the same issues as a dedicated hosting solution, you cannot go beyond the power of a single machine.

This problem is common enough that it has led to changes in the way websites are hosted, and the techniques that have come into use are now called "Cloud Hosting", where instead of having a single

computer serving a single website, you have numerous computers serving numerous websites.

A website with cloud hosting could be running on any number of servers at a given time. To start off, only one "instance" of your webserver is running, and you are charged for a single instance only. However as the load on your

server increases, other instances of your website could be launched to ease the burden. A load balancing system ensures that no server is overloaded and that the end-user can continue accessing the website transparently.

Cloud hosting relies on virtualization of resources.



VISITING A WEBSITE

A Web user types www.thinkdigit.com in his Web browser. At this stage, there's no way to find where the website is hosted -- it could be hosted on any number of servers, and tracing the IP to one dedicated server isn't always possible in a cloud hosting setup. Also, with a single user visiting ThinkDigit.com, there isn't enough load on the cloud hosting setup.